

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 824

By Yager

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize the centennial anniversary of Alvin C. York Agricultural Institute.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in commemorating the 100th anniversary of one of this State's most vital educational institutions, namely Alvin C. York Agricultural Institute of Jamestown, Fentress County; and

WHEREAS, the school, also known as Alvin C. York Institute or York Institute, is a Tennessee public high school that was founded as a private agricultural school in 1926 by local World War I hero Alvin C. York; and

WHEREAS, transferred to the State of Tennessee in 1937, York Institute continues to operate today as a living memorial to Sergeant Alvin C. York; and

WHEREAS, York Institute is unique as the only comprehensive secondary school in the United States that is financed and operated by a state government; and

WHEREAS, Alvin C. York established the school that carries his name during the 1920s in the county seat (Jamestown) of his home county of Fentress; his stated goal was to give rural children the chance to obtain a high school education; and

WHEREAS, Sergeant York began touring the United States in 1919 to raise funds for the school; using his status as a war hero to attract public attention, he raised a total of \$10,000; and

WHEREAS, he also solicited and received funds from the General Assembly, which contributed \$50,000, and Fentress County, which pledged \$50,000; and

WHEREAS, classes began at York Institute in 1929, and the school operated privately until 1937, when financial pressures related to the Great Depression led Alvin C. York to transfer the school to the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, in accordance with its motto, Alvin C. York Institute continues to serve as a model rural school of excellence where all stakeholders "Prepare and Excel" for the challenges and opportunities of the future; and

WHEREAS, Alvin C. York Institute seeks to educate, empower, and enable all students to become productive citizens by developing high expectations, fostering individual student success, and creating a community of respect, responsibility, and pride; and

WHEREAS, for 100 years, York Institute has helped shape the young men and women of Fentress County into responsible members of society; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and recognize the centennial anniversary of Alvin C. York Agricultural Institute and commend the school's administration, faculty, staff, students, parents, and other stakeholders for their ongoing commitment to excellence in secondary education.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.